St Michael's Parish, Blackrock

25/10/2026

30th Sunday Ordinary Time

Email : parish@stmichaelsblackrock.ie Website: www.stmichaelsblackrock.ie
Facebook: www.facebook.com/stmichaelsblackrock | Parish Mobile No. (086) 813 6877

https://www.stmichaelsblackrock.ie/

WEEKLY MASS LEAFLET UPDATES:
Email to : parish@stmichaelsblackrock.ie

1703

BAPTISMS: Please contact the Parish Office
MARRIAGES: Minimum 3 months notice required by Church and State.
Pre-marriage course required.

Mass Times

Sundays: 9 am & 11 am
Saturday Vigil: 6.00 pm
Tuesday & Friday: 9.30 am

Baptisms are held on the 2nd and 4th Saturdays of each month at 4pm.

Fr. Michael Keohane Co-PP



Deceased
Joe Twomey, Late of Dripsey, Cork / Blackrock, Cork
Rest in Peace



Families



- Ninety children from four schools enrolled for the Sacraments of First Confession and First Holy Communion last weekend. There was a great attendance at the Vigil Mass for this and we look forward to the other Do This in Memory Masses both before and after Christmas in preparation for the Sacraments. The beauty of this is that ninety families were also in attendance as well as many grandparents. This brings life to our parish for which we are all grateful. The enrolment ceremony for the Confirmation candidates has been arranged for Saturday 21st November at 6pm Mass. Again, we look forward to all their families attending as well. There will be at least one more Mass for the Confirmation candidates in the new year to ensure that preparation is part of parish life along with their families and schools. May God bless all the children, young people, their families, schools and our parish. - Fr. Michael

Confirmations 2027

Mon. 22nd Feb	Scoil na Croise Naofa (in Holy Cross)
Tue. 9th Mar.	Gaelscoil Mhachan (in Holy Cross)
Wed. 14th Apr.	Beaumont GNS & BNS, Scoil Ursula & St. Michael's NS.

November Novena for the Dead: Monday 2nd - Tuesday 10th November. There will be Mass each weekday @ 9.30am during the Novena.

Blessing of the Graves – in St. Michael's Cemetery on Sunday 8th November @ 3pm.

November Novena Envelopes - available from the church from this weekend. Please return on/before Monday 2nd November, Feast of All Souls.

Children's Adoration – Friday 6th November from 3pm – 3.30pm in St. Michael's, Blackrock.

Altar Servers – there are more volunteers and look forward to a growing number of boys and girls willing to join the team with the support and encouragement of their families. People really appreciate the involvement of our new altar servers.

Alpha for Adults & Youth Alpha – will take place in Blackrock Parish Centre commencing on 6th January 2027. – more details available soon.

Fr. Michael 085 8735905 frmichael@corkandross.org

A brief introduction on Sunday's readings

• First Reading (Exodus 22:20–26):
God commands the Israelites not to wrong or oppress aliens, widows, orphans, or the poor. He warns that He hears their cries and will act with compassion and justice toward the helpless. Explore further study resources via Catholic Productions.
• Second Reading (1 Thessalonians 1:5c–10):
St. Paul praises the Thessalonians for turning away from idols to serve the living God and for living out the faith with joy through the Holy Spirit, becoming an example to believers everywhere.
• Gospel (Matthew 22:34–40):
When tested by a Pharisee about the greatest commandment, Jesus summarizes the entire Law and Prophets into two inseparable pillars: love God with all your heart, soul, and mind, and love your neighbor as yourself.

The Papers Say.....

Irish Catholic. (1). New Series —. The Beehive. — Faith Formation for All. (2). David Quinn: The irony and injustice of Ireland's new cold climate for Jews. 'When old anti-Jewish conspiracy theories rear their heads again, we have a problem'. See also article by Maurice Cohen of the Jewish Representative Council of Ireland. (3). Editorial. — The Spirit asked for Catechists. — Why all the secrecy? (4). Fr. Gerard Condon: Nano Nagle and the return to origins (5). Margaret Hickey : Richard Boyd-Barrett, the monks , the singer and the billionaire.

Tablet of 17/10. (1). The power of Adoration. (2). Archbishop Paul Gallagher: The Church diplomats promote the common good of all peoples and maintain lines of dialogue with every nation — even when it risks misunderstanding and derision. (3). Permanent deacons. In the first of a new series a married father of three and a maths teacher explains why he offered to train as a permanent deacon and how the role has changed his life.

Ireland's 3rd National First Saturdays Conference

This year's conference will take place in Knock on Saturday November 28th. The day begins at 10am and finishes at 5pm. It includes Holy Mass, adoration, talks, and a healing service. Speakers include: Fr Patrick Cahill, Geraldine O'Donnell, Fr Leon Pereira OP, Nikki Kingsley, Fr Marius O'Reilly, Fr. Jaimie Twohig, Christine O'Hara, Fr. Mark Quinn, and Fr Philip Kemmy, Fr. John Keane will lead a Eucharistic Healing Service. More information and the list of buses going are available on www.firstsaturdays.ie. At Fatima Our Lady promised that if we did what she asked there would be peace in the world and that many souls would be saved.

Family of Parishes Meeting - Wednesday 28th October @ 7pm in Blackrock Parish Centre. Representatives from the four parishes in our Family of Parishes will meet to further deepen the strong working relationship between the parishes.

Gentle reminder!!
For those attending with young children, if required, there is a Family Room available at the top left inside the church. Thanks.



BLACKROCK ST VINCENT DE PAUL
Church Gate collection will take place on Week ending 1st November
Your support as always is greatly appreciated.
THERE WILL BE ONLY 1 COLLECTION ON THE SVP WEEKEND

Annual Remembrance Mass - for all those who have died from our parish over the last year will be celebrated on Monday 2nd November @ 7pm.
They have gone no further than to God and God is very near.

Reflections

1. You may feel some sympathy with the Jews struggling to cope with 613 laws and wondering which were the important ones. But have you ever felt overwhelmed by the rules and regulations of your own tradition? And have you ever been blessed by meeting someone, or reading something, that was able to cut through all the layers and point out to you what is essential in life? Who was that person? What did s/he say or do? Is there some phrase or text that encapsulates such wisdom for you?
2. If you were asked what is most im- portant in life, what would your answer be? Recall the experiences and relationships you have had. Which are the ones that you treasure most? What has particularly enriched your life? How would you encourage another person who asked you how s/he could live a full life?

PRAYER
Your love, O God is boundless. We who were strangers have been made your children. We who were defenceless have been brought into your household. Keep us mindful of your deeds of mercy, that we may love you with all our heart and love our neighbour as ourselves.
We ask this through our Lord Jesus Christ, your Son, who lives and reigns with you in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God for ever and ever. Amen.

Unfolding the Word: *What Mark's Gospel says about discipleship.*
An Invitation to our family of Parishes
Why not join us on Thursdays 5th 12th 19th and 26th November in the Parish room in Holy Cross Church, Mahon from 7.30 pm to 9.00 pm.
An opportunity to come together and spend some time reading and discussing the Scriptures, followed by prayer.
Everyone is most welcome and we even have a cuppa and chat afterwards as well!

October Choirs' Concert: Raised €7130.00. Thank you! A special thank you to all the choirs who participated. We thank friend PJ Coogan (96FM) who acted as MC on the night. We thank Msgr Gearoid Dullea and the Parish Council for allowing us to have our concert in Our Lady of Lourdes' Church, Ballinlough and to Ruth and Helen for organising it.

FIRST FRIDAY EXPOSITION OF THE BLESSED SACRAMENT
Rosary and Benediction will commence at 4pm. each First Friday. There are time sheets on the tables in the Church where Parishioners can indicate the times most suitable for them to attend. We would like, if possible, if there could be 2 people present for each period. If there are vacant periods we would appreciate volunteers to fill these times by putting their names on the list. THANK YOU FOR YOUR CO-OPERATION.



Mass Cards are available in the sacristy after every mass both at weekend and weekdays.

Sunday Cuppa continues in the Parish Centre after 11 am mass on 1st November for tea, bikkies and more chat!
Cheaper than the village - it's free!
Everyone welcome - Ah go on!



Thought for the day

Jesus does not pluck his summary teaching from the air— he quotes from the Shema Yisrael, the great daily prayer of Judaism found in Deuteronomy 6. The second part about the love of neighbour is taken from Leviticus 18. This mission statement stands as a resounding appeal to us today. We are asked not just to believe that there is a God, but to love God. We are asked not just to respect our neighbour, but to love our neighbour. Love is not only the truth about human beings but also the truth about God, who is love itself.

Prayer
Great and loving God, your love for us is beyond what we can grasp with our minds and hearts. Let such great love for all awaken in us a true love of you and lead to authentic service of our neighbour.
Kieran O'Mahony OSA

ENTRANCE –
Hail Queen of Heaven

Hail, Queen of heav'n, the ocean Star:
Guide of the wand'rer here below,
Thrown on life's surge, we claim thy care;
Save us from peril and from woe.
Mother of Christ, Star of the Sea,
Pray for the wand'rer, pray for me.

O gentle, chaste, and spotless Maid,
We sinners make our prayers through thee;
Remind thy Son that He has paid
The price of our iniquity.
Virgin most pure, Star of the sea,
Pray for the sinner, pray for me.

RECESSIONAL -
How Great Thou Art

Oh Lord, my God, when I in awesome wonder
consider all the worlds Thy hands have made
I see the stars, I hear the rolling thunder,
thy power throughout the universe displayed.

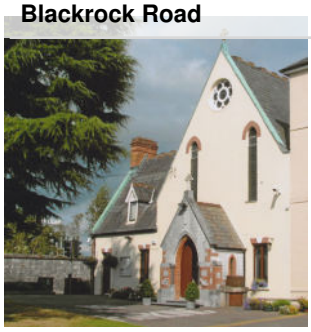
CHORUS: Then sings my soul, my Saviour God to thee:
How great Thou art, how great Thou art.
Then sings my soul, my Saviour God to thee:
How great Thou art, how great Thou art.

When Christ shall come with shout of acclamation
and take me home, what joy shall fill my heart;
Then I shall bow, in humble adoration,
And then proclaim, my God, how great Thou art.

PARISH DEFIBRILLATORS

There are 2 Defibrillators located in the Parish, one in the village & one outside Murphy's Circle K Petrol Station. The code to operate both is 2017





St. Joseph's (SMA Church) Blackrock Road Parish
within the Family of Parishes:
Ballinlough, Blackrock, Blackrock Road and Mahon.

Fr. John Denvir, SMA Co-PP Fr Jérôme Anoumou-Sassou, SMA CC

Email: parish.blackrock@sma.ie
Webcam: churchservices.tv/smablackrock
Parish webpage: https://sma.ie/sma-parish-blackrock-road-cork/
Parish Office: 4616328. Hours: Monday and Friday 10 am - 4 pm
Priest on call: 087 4744341 Sick Calls

Thirtieth Sunday in Ordinary Time 25th October 2026

Mass Times

Sunday: 10.00 am and 12 Noon.
Ballintemple National School, Portacabin, Boreenmanna Road.

Intentions for Sunday Masses

10:00 am Sunday: Pro Populo.
12 Noon Sunday: Kathleen Lyons RIP Anniversary.

Remembrance/ Anniversaries: Thomas and Mary Lester. Finbar Lawless. Phyllis Humphreys. Joe Davenport. Aunt Josie (England) RIP.

Church Roof and Ceiling under Maintenance:

i. Sunday Masses, are celebrated in the Portacabin, at Ballintemple National School, Boreenmanna Road. There are no weekday Masses in the Church.
ii. Funerals, Baptisms and Weddings are celebrated in Saint Michael's Church, Blackrock. Please book these celebrations through Saint Joseph's (SMA) Parish Office, on 021 4616328. The Parish SMA Fathers will celebrate these occasions in Saint Michael's, once booked with the SMA Parish Office.

We ask you to continue to be supportive of our Parish.
You can support the Parish by any of the following: Please consider :
Cheque Cash Credit Transfer Standing Order.
The Bank Account Number for receipt of Credit Transfers and Standing Orders is:
IBAN IE97 BOFI 9028 1366 4151 45 BIC BOFIIE2D
Account Name: Society of African Missions.

🎶🎹 October Choirs' Concert: Raised €7130.00. Thank you! A special thank you to all the choirs who participated. We thank our friend PJ Coogan (96FM) who acted as MC on the night. We thank Msgr Gearoid Dullea and the Parish Council for allowing us to have our concert in Our Lady of Lourdes' Church, Ballinlough and to Ruth and Helen for organising it.

✝ **Blessing of Graves:** Sunday 8th November at 3:00 pm in St. Michael's Cemetery, Blackrock.



⛪ **Family of Parishes Meeting:** "Building on the Year of Prayer, Listening and Discernment". Wednesday 28th October at 7:00 pm in Blackrock Parish Centre. Fr. John is looking for 6 representatives from our parish. The session will last no more than two hours and will involve prayer, conversation and discernment of the next steps together. Lorraine Buckley and Jim Deeds will be present on the night. If you are interested, kindly contact Fr. John Denvir. **He needs six.people.**

🌍 **Synodal Pathway: Conversation in the Spirit:** The synod has been an authentic spiritual experience - indeed, it would be more accurate to describe it as an experience "in the Spirit". The category of an experience in the Spirit now invites us to adopt it as a key for interpreting the ecclesial processes presently underway. One of the most significant features accompanying the synodal experience of these years has been the choice of "conversation in the Spirit" as its method. The effort required of everyone - indeed, of everyone - to arrive at a new awareness capable of grasping the substantial difference between spiritual conversation (as a thematic exercise) and conversation in the Spirit(that is, entering into the self-giving and self - communication of the Risen Lord among us through the work of the Spirit) has itself become a testimony to the cry of faith dwelling in "Ecclesiae in Synodo perficienda" ("the Church finding its fulfillment in the synod"). We desire to encounter the Risen Lord; we desire to experience and live concretely our identity as disciples.
Beyond the method itself, what struck so many participants was the discovery that ecclesial discernment consists not primarily in the exchange of opinions or confrontation of ideas, but in a shared search for what the Spirit is saying to the churches today. **(Cardinal Mario Grech, Secretary General of the Synod of Bishops, at the extraordinary consistory of bishops, convened at the Vatican 26-27 June 2026).**

📅 **Date for your Diary:** Alpha for Adults and Youth Alpha will take place in Blackrock Parish Centre commencing on 6th January 2027 - more details available soon.

📖 **Unfolding the Word: What Mark's Gospel says about Discipleship:** Join us on Thursdays 5th, 12th, 19th and 26th November in the Parish room in Holy Cross Church, Mahon from 7:30pm - 9:00 pm. An opportunity to come together and spend some time reading and discussing the Scriptures, followed by prayer. Everyone is most welcome and we even have a cuppa and chat afterwards as well! This would also be a great formation for all Readers in the Family of parishes!

💶 **Second Collection:** Church Renovation